



MakerCompass

Stop putting your life's work off.

Maker Compass turns a rough software idea into the market context, product plan, first-version scope, mockups, technical direction, and build-ready next step a serious builder needs.

POSITIONING

The step before the build. Judgment, not generation: AI made software easier to produce, not easier to make meaningful.

PRIMARY AUDIENCE

Founders and indie builders carrying one idea they have not turned into a real first version.

ANCHOR PERSONA

Priya, 31

Senior engineer with a side project she has restarted four times. Every restart ends the same way: auth, a settings page, and no answer to who it is for. She does not need help writing code.

SECONDARY

Operators pressure-testing an idea before asking for headcount. Consultants scoping other people's ideas.

The mark is a bearing, not a compass rose.



A solid wedge rotated 32° off vertical with a notched tail. The rotation is the idea: a direction already chosen, not a centred needle still deciding. Below 32px the notch collapses, so small exports use a simplified silhouette at identical optical weight.

Wordmark: one solid word, **Maker** at weight 800 against **Compass** at weight 500, tracking -0.045em. The weight break carries the hierarchy and survives being flattened to one colour.



HORIZONTAL • 1.3 CAP



STACKED • 1.9 CAP



SYMBOL ALONE

Clear space is one cap height on all four sides.

#DC2626

Action Red

Commitment. Max 10% of a screen.

#1C1917

Workshop Black

Text, dark surfaces.

#4A4040

Slate Plum

Second-tier text, focus ring.

#F5F0EB

Warm Paper

Secondary surface, chrome.

#FAFAFA

Cloud

Page ground. Never pure white.

TYPOGRAPHY

Hanken Grotesk 800

Body sets at weight 400, 1rem, line-height 1.6. Display and headline tracking is -0.05em, never flat zero. One family carries the whole hierarchy.

FIRA MONO / METADATA VOICE / 0.18EM

Mono uppercase is reserved for kickers, status, and metadata. Never Hanken small caps.

VOICE

“Generation is cheap now. Judgment is not.”

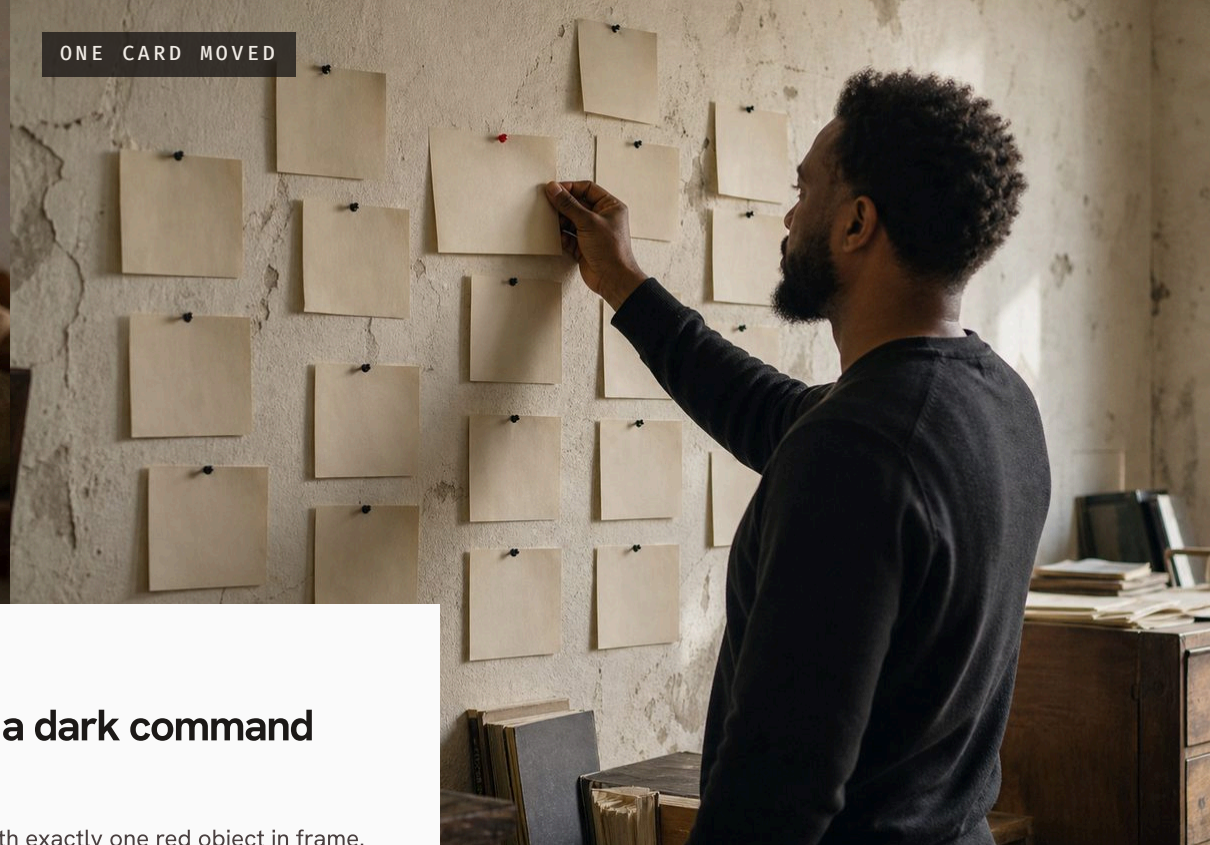
Quietly direct, anti-hype, specific, constructively critical. Short sentences, plain verbs, no em dashes. Say “first version” more than “MVP”.

Never: unlock, supercharge, revolutionize, 10x, powered by AI, seamless, effortless, elevate, curated, premium, cutting-edge.

SORTING SCOPE



ONE CARD MOVED



VISUAL WORLD

A lit workshop, not a dark command center.

Real light only. Warm neutrals with exactly one red object in frame.
Film grain always. Subjects work, they do not address the camera.
Cast is diverse by default, named per prompt.

Deliberately pre-digital: the thinking happens before the tooling.

03 / 04



LAPTOP CLOSED

COMMITTED TO PAPER



Where the mark has to survive first.



APP ICON / AVATAR



FAVICON, TRUE SIZE

Simplified silhouette below 32px.
Never scale a large export down.



HOW IT WORKS

EXAMPLE

Start with your idea

BEFORE YOU BUILD

Stop putting your life's work off.

Give it the rough idea. Get back the market context, the first version worth building, the scope to hold it to, and where to start.

WHAT COMES BACK

Market context

First-version scope

Mockups

Technical direction

WEB HERO DIRECTION / SHARP CORNERS, RED ON ONE ELEMENT ONLY



PRODUCT IN CONTEXT / SCREENS SHOW REAL OUTPUT

- DO
- ✓ Leave one full cap height of clear space around the lockup, including social crops.
 - ✓ Let one element dominate. Flat hierarchy is the tell of an undesigned page.
 - ✓ Name the artifact ("your first-version scope"), not the feature.
- DON ' T
- ✗ Don't use red for errors or focus rings. Errors are #C0392B, focus is #4A4040.
 - ✗ Don't set display type at flat tracking. -0.05em or it reads as a wireframe.
 - ✗ Don't ship a gradient hero, glass panel, sparkle, or "Powered by AI" badge.